

the reach of FOSS in India. Sriram Saroop's keynote on the topic 'Simplify OSS Development' and the plenary session on WikiBhasha by Naren Datha, researcher, Microsoft Research India, had a similar agenda. A panel discussion on the topic 'FOSS Jobs—Trends, Industry Expectations, Opportunities and Challenges', was led by Sreekandh Balakrishnan (an independent consultant), with such eminent industry representatives as Rohit Kumar Rai (EnterpriseDB), Jyothi Bacche (MindTree Consulting), Vikas Joshi (Texas Instruments), Aseem Jakhar (Payatu Technologies) and Vartika Agarwal (Yahoo! Inc) as participants. Everyone agreed that open source has to be introduced in the educational system much earlier, and students in school should get familiarised with using user-friendly versions of Linux.

FOSS for developers

FOSS sessions for developers formed a major chunk of the conference as they included presentations on Web development, mobile development, database, PHP and kernel development, etc. A wide variety of topics were covered, such as, 'Extending SugarCRM for Building a Large Scale Federal Level Application' by Ben Schooley and Sue Feldman of SmartWorks, 'Got Units?' by Alessandro Nadalin of DNSEE, 'Jugaad—the Linux Thread Injection Kit' by Aseem Jakhar of Payatu Technologies, 'NewSQL: For 'SPRAINED' DBMS' by B V P Vamsi Krishna, S Nirmala and R Prasanna Venkatesh of Huawei India, and so on.

Bastian Feder, freelance author and trainer, and a veteran speaker at several international conferences, took a session titled, 'Pack Your Bundle', where participants learnt about the console to generate a skeleton for a personalised bundle. He walked the audience through each step of making use of and fine tuning the generated bundle. Tobias Schlitt of Qafoo GmbH spoke about improving software maintainability and making it future proof. He also took a session on 'Apache Zeta Components', which is an open source component library that provides codes for accessing databases, sending emails and other such free services. "The library makes it easier for developers to get faster results as they need not build it from scratch," he shared. There were over 10 sessions dedicated to PHP, including talks on cloud computing, documentation, tools and libraries.

The audience particularly enjoyed sessions such as: 'Introducing BeagleBone: The all new \$89 open source, hardware enthusiasts platform on TI's AM335x' by Khasim Syed Mohammed of Texas Instruments, 'Kernel 3.0' by Varad Gupta of Keen & Able Computers, and 'Cross Platform Mobile Application Development, Using Phonegap' by Prashant Patil of MindTree.

FOSS for CIOs

In these sessions, speakers simplified the jargon for CIOs and technology heads who were not familiar with FOSS, and explained how they could benefit from open source tools, databases and the cloud. Gil Yehuda of Yahoo Inc presented a talk on 'Using open source to commoditise your technology' and showed how Yahoo! leveraged open source as an economic model to generate revenue. He spoke about how an enterprise can generate business using FOSS by developing or supporting open source. He spoke about the economics



Juozas Kazukenas, CEO, Web Species Ltd, one of the international speakers at OSI, having a look at the content line-up to zero in on a session of his choice



Tobias Schlitt, PHP expert and co-founder, Qafoo GmbH, sharing '10 Golden Rules Of Thumb'



Varad Gupta, chief technology officer, Keen & Able Computers, talking about Kernel 3.0 at the Kernel Day track



Arne Blankerts, co-founder and principal consultant at thePHPcc, Germany, delivering a talk on 'Deployment - Annoyment?'